

Exercise Spirak §1, P15

Prove that if $x, y \neq 0$, then

$$x^3 + xy + y^3 > 0 \quad (*)$$

Pf Note that

$$x^3 - y^3 = (x - y)(x^2 + xy + y^2)$$

Case 1 $x = y$

Then $(*)$ is $x^2 + x^2 + x^2 > 0$

Case 2 $x > y$

Then $x^3 > y^3$

This is equivalent to

$$x^3 - y^3 > 0.$$

Then $\underbrace{(x - y)}_{> 0} (x^2 + xy + y^2) > 0$

* Assumed

$$x > y$$

$$\text{So } x - y > 0$$

$$\text{So } x^2 + xy + y^2 > 0.$$

II. Numbers of Various Sorts

$$\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$$

$\Rightarrow$ Mathematical induction

(If you want to define $\mathbb{N}$ from a small set of axioms induction is one of them $\Rightarrow$ Peano Arithmetic)

If $P(k)$ is a statement that is either true or false for each value of $k \in \mathbb{N}$.

and if: ① $P(1)$ is true
② If $P(k)$ is true, then $P(k+1)$ is true.

$\Rightarrow$ Then, $P(k)$ is true for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$.
In $\mathbb{N}$, this is taken as an axiom.

Ex. Show that $P(k)$ is true for all k .

$$P(k) = 1 + \dots + k = \frac{k(k+1)}{2}$$

Pf. Taking induction for granted.

need to verify ① and ② to show that $P(k)$ is true $\forall k$.

① $P(1)$: $1 = \frac{1(1+1)}{2} = 1$. True

②. Assume $P(k)$ is true
want $P(k+1)$ is true

Add $k+1$ to both sides

$$(1 + \dots + k) + (k+1) = \frac{k(k+1)}{2} + k+1$$

$$\stackrel{(pq)}{=} (k+1) \left(\frac{k}{2} + 1 \right)$$

$$= (k+1) \left(\frac{k+2}{2} \right)$$

By induction, $P(k)$ is true $\forall k$.



Well-ordering Principle

if $A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, $A \neq \emptyset$

then A has the least element

This is equivalent to induction.

PF (Induction $\Rightarrow$ WOP)

Suppose for a contradiction that

$\exists A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, $A \neq \emptyset$ without a least element.

Define $P(k)$: $1, \dots, k \in A$

Apply induction to P .

① Is $P(1)$ true?

Yes, if $1 \in A$, then 1 is its least element.

② Assume $P(k)$ is true. Show $P(k+1)$ true

$\Rightarrow$ At least one of $1, 2, \dots, k+1 \in A$ $\left. \vphantom{\begin{matrix} \Rightarrow \\ \text{At least one of } 1, 2, \dots, k+1 \in A \end{matrix}} \right\} \begin{matrix} k+1 \in A \\ \text{But } P(k) \text{ says } 1, \dots, k \in A \end{matrix}$

In this case, $k+1$ is the least element of A

Since A was assumed to have a least element, this is a contradiction.



(WOP $\Rightarrow$ Induction)

Assume every $\emptyset \neq A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ has a least element

Let $A = \{k \in \mathbb{N} : p(k) \text{ is false}\}$

If A were not empty, by WOP, it has least element $l \in A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$.

($p(l)$ is false)

So, $l \neq 1$ since $p(l)$ is false.

$p(l-1)$ is true b/c l is the least elt in A .

By induction, $p(l-1)$ true $\Rightarrow p(l)$ true

So $l \notin A$, contradiction $\Rightarrow A = \emptyset$



Strong Induction

$P(k)$ property that is true or false for each $k \in \mathbb{N}$.

Assume ① $P(1)$ is true.

② If $P(1), \dots, P(k-1)$ all true
 $\Rightarrow P(k)$ is true.

Then, $P(k)$ true for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$.